

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 10

Reviewing Coping Card & Continuing Relapse Prevention Planning

Fictional Educational Example — Full Detailed

SESSION INFORMATION

Client: RK (35 y/o Male)

Therapist: Dr. A.

Session #: 10 of 16

Focus: Coping Card review + Relapse prevention planning

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client brought a well-prepared Coping Card. Belief in the old perfectionistic thought remains low (~20-25%). He has been practicing Worry Postponement consistently. Today we will review the Coping Card, continue building the relapse prevention plan (Action Plan if symptoms return), review recent experiments, and assign homework focused on maintaining gains.

SESSION START & HOMEWORK REVIEW

Therapist: Good morning, RK. How has your week been? I see you brought your Coping Card — that looks really well done.

Client: Thanks. It was helpful to write everything down in one place. I've been using it when I notice early warning signs. The experiments are also going well — I feel much more confident now.

Therapist: That's great to hear. Can you tell me about one situation where you used the Coping Card or one of your strategies?

Client: Last Tuesday I started worrying a lot before a meeting. I noticed my chest getting tight (early warning sign). Instead of spiraling, I told myself "I'll deal with this during Worry Time" and then used the balanced belief. It helped me calm down before the meeting.

Therapist: That's excellent use of the tools. You caught it early and used two different strategies. How did the meeting go?

Client: It went fine. I didn't over-prepare everything, and I still felt prepared enough. I'm starting to trust that I don't need to be perfect.

REVIEWING THE COPING CARD

Therapist: Your Coping Card looks very clear and practical. Let's go through it quickly together.

Early Warning Signs (on your card):

- Increased daily worry time
- Returning to over-checking and over-preparing
- Sleep disturbance starting again
- Avoiding meetings or social interactions

Top Coping Strategies (on your card):

- Use thought record or balanced belief immediately
- Practice Worry Time / Postponement
- Do a quick behavioral experiment if fear feels strong
- Use problem-solving steps instead of worrying
- Talk to wife instead of withdrawing

Therapist: This is a very solid plan. Which strategy do you think you'll use the most when warning signs appear?

Client: Probably the balanced belief and Worry Postponement. Those two have helped me the most so far.

ACTION PLAN IF SYMPTOMS RETURN

Therapist: Now let's build the next part of your relapse prevention plan — what you will actually ****do**** if you notice several warning signs for more than a few days.

Action Plan we developed together:

1. Increase use of daily thought records and Worry Postponement for 1 week
2. Do at least one behavioral experiment related to the current fear
3. Review the Coping Card daily and rate mood and worry time
4. If symptoms do not improve after 7–10 days or start significantly affecting work or relationships → Contact therapist for a booster session

Client: That feels clear and manageable. I like having a clear "what to do" plan instead of just hoping it gets better.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week:

1. Continue daily diary + Worry Time / Postponement
2. Practice using your Coping Card when you notice any warning signs
3. Do one more behavioral experiment focused on a remaining fear

4. Write down your personal Action Plan clearly (we can refine it next session)

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we reviewed your excellent use of the tools and started building a clear relapse prevention plan with Early Warning Signs, Top Coping Strategies, and an Action Plan. How does having this written down feel?

Client: It feels reassuring. I now have a concrete plan instead of just hoping I won't relapse.

Therapist: That's exactly the goal. Any questions?

Client: No, everything is clear.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Client showing strong ownership of his coping tools and relapse prevention plan.
- Belief in old core thought remains low and stable.
- Relapse prevention planning is progressing well.
- Next session: Review Action Plan, continue experiments, deepen relapse prevention (booster session planning), prepare for final phase of therapy.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.